Test 3:

READING PASSAGE 1

*You should spend about 20 minutes on **Questions 1–13**, which are based on Reading Passage 1 below.*

The Pyramid of Cestius

A 2000-year-old pyramid in the city of Rome has been restored by archaeologists

Though Rome draws tourists from around the world to its many impressive sites, one notable monument there has never attracted nearly as much interest: The Pyramid of Cestius. But why would there be a pyramid in Italy? After the Roman conquest of Egypt in 30 B.C., Egyptian architectural style became fashionable in Rome. Though obelisks and other monuments inspired by Egypt's great pyramids sprung up around the city, only two actual pyramids are known to have been built. The only one left standing, the Pyramid of Cestius, was designed as the burial pyramid for a Roman politician named Caius Cestius, who ordered that the building work be completed within a period of 330 days.

Construction took place at some point between 18 B.C. and 12 B.C. Cestius pyramid had a layer of white Carrara marble on the outside, and was constructed from brick held together by a basic kind of cement on the inside. One of the things that strikes you when you look at the pyramid is how steep it is, so that the shape of Cestius' pyramid is quite unlike that of typical Egyptian ones. This is a difference that could have been the result of inaccurate information sent back to Rome by soldiers who saw the pyramids in person in Egypt. Alternatively, Roman builders could have drawn inspiration from the pyramids in Nubia, a region located in what is today northern Sudan and southern Egypt.

At the time of its construction, since there was a strict Roman law prohibiting the placement of tombs within the city itself, the Pyramid of Cestius would have stood in countryside. Rome grew enormously during the next two centuries, and by the 3rd century A.D., the pyramid would have been surrounded by buildings. We also know that in the 3rd century A.D., the Pyramid of Cestius was hidden behind a high wall on the orders of Emperor Aurelian; this probably helped it survive throughout the centuries to come, even as other ancient monuments disappeared.

By the Middle Ages, the pyramid was covered in vegetation and thick dirt, and popular myth had developed that it might be a tomb for one of the twin brothers Romulus and Remus, who were regarded as the men who had established the city of Rome. Cestius actual tomb within the pyramid and the inscription identifying the pyramid as his, weren't rediscovered until the 1660s when the pyramid underwent restoration. During excavations, when trees and plants were cleared away, two marble bases were found in front of the pyramid, as well as fragments of bronze statues that had once stood on them on either side of the pyramid. The people employed to excavate the pyramid did not find the urn that would have contained

Cestius' remains, but they did come across a tunnel. It was quite possible, therefore, that robbers had at some earlier time removed the contents of the tomb. But while some of the features of Cestius' tomb no longer exist, at least the pyramid itself has survived.

Today, the foundations of Cestius pyramid rest below street level near an intersection with heavy traffic, so that passing tourists and residents could easily fail to notice its full height of 119 feet. Across the intersection is the Piramide station, located on Line B of the Rome Metro. In 2011, the Japanese clothing company entrepreneur Yuzo Yagi, president of Yagi Tsusho Ltd, announced his intention to help the Italian government pay for an ambitious renovation of the Pyramid of Cestius. 'It's an act of gratitude,' he later told journalists. 'Our company has grown thanks to Italy.' Work began at the site shortly after Yagi signed an official agreement with the Special Superintendency for the Archaeological Heritage of Rome, and was completed ahead of schedule thanks to his 2-million-euro contribution.

As archaeologist Leonardo Guarnieri explained to journalists, officials are now conducting tours of the newly renovated pyramid twice a month by reservation. Visitors who take advantage of the tour can make their way through a narrow corridor in order to enter the burial chamber itself. It is within these walls that they can admire the frescoes: watercolour paintings typical of the time. In the chamber, it is possible to make out four frescoes of the winged Roman goddess of war, Victoria, a figure from Roman legend, as well as a series of vases, the type that would have been used for special rituals and purification purposes. We know from the writings of earlier visitors that there used to be more here, but the majority have disappeared over time.

Only one problem remains now that the restoration is complete. The white exterior of the Pyramid of Cestius will have to be cleaned every few months to remove the layer of urban pollution. A team of free-climbers will be employed to do the job, in order to avoid placing builder's scaffolding around the newly welcoming monument.

Questions 1–7

Do the following statements agree with the information given in Reading Passage 1?

*In boxes **1–7** on your answer sheet, write:*

TRUE	if the statement agrees with the information
FALSE	if the statement contradicts the information
NOT GIVEN	if there is no information on this

1. The Pyramid of Cestius has always been one of Rome's most popular tourist attractions.

2. The construction of the Pyramid was completed before Cestius' death.

3. In the Middle Ages, people thought an original founder of Rome was buried in the Pyramid of Cestius.

4. Today the height of the Pyramid is something that tourists and residents immediately notice.

5. Japanese businessman Yuzo Yagi was an admirer of both Italian and Egyptian architecture.

6. The restoration of the Pyramid of Cestius, which was funded by Yuzo Yagi, finished earlier than expected.

7. Most of the original frescoes inside Cestius' tomb have survived to this day.

Questions 8–13

Complete the notes below.

*Choose **ONE WORD ONLY** from the passage for each answer.*

*Write your answers in boxes **8–13** on your answer sheet.*

History of the Pyramid of Cestius

Construction of Cestius' pyramid

- it was made from **8** _____ marble and cement
- its **9** _____ is different to the pyramids found in Egypt
- it was originally built in the **10** _____ as building tombs in the city was forbidden
- Emperor Aurelian ordered that a wall had to be built around it

Restoration of Cestius' pyramid in the 1660s

- in the 1660s, some broken **11** _____ were found next to it
- the **12** _____ inside the tomb suggests that robbers had been there
- the frescoes show mythological scenes, and images of vases

Restoration of Cestius' pyramid today

- a Japanese businessman paid for its restoration
- climbers are helping to get rid of signs of **13** _____.

ĐÁP ÁN:

1. FALSE
(Văn bản nói rằng di tích này chưa bao giờ thu hút được nhiều sự quan tâm như các địa điểm khác ở Rome)
Đoạn chứa đáp án: one notable monument there has never attracted nearly as much interest: The Pyramid of Cestius.

2. **NOT GIVEN**
(Chỉ đề cập Cestius ra lệnh hoàn thành trong 330 ngày, không nói rõ nó xong trước hay sau khi ông ấy qua đời).

*Đoạn chứa đáp án:*The only one left standing, the Pyramid of Cestius, was designed as the burial pyramid for a Roman politician named Caius Cestius, who ordered that the building work be completed within a period of 330 days.

3. **TRUE**
(Thời Trung cổ có truyền thuyết cho rằng đó là lăng mộ của Romulus hoặc Remus - những người sáng lập ra Rome).

*Đoạn chứa đáp án:*By the Middle Ages, the pyramid was covered in vegetation and thick dirt, and popular myth had developed that it might be a tomb for one of the twin brothers Romulus and Remus, who were regarded as the men who had established the city of Rome.

4. FALSE
(Do móng nằm dưới tầng mặt đất và gần giao lộ đông đúc nên du khách và người dân có thể không nhận ra chiều cao đầy đủ của nó).

Đoạn chứa đáp án: Today, the foundations of Cestius pyramid rest below street level near an intersection with heavy traffic, so that passing tourists and residents could easily fail to notice its full height of 119 feet.

5. NOT GIVEN
(Ông Yuzo Yagi đóng góp tiền vì lòng biết ơn nước Ý, không đề cập việc ông có ngưỡng mộ kiến trúc Ai Cập hay không).

Đoạn chứa đáp án: In 2011, the Japanese clothing company entrepreneur Yuzo Yagi, president of Yagi Tsusho Ltd, announced his intention to help the Italian government pay for

an ambitious renovation of the Pyramid of Cestius. 'It's an act of gratitude,' he later told journalists. 'Our company has grown thanks to Italy.'

6. TRUE
(Quá trình trùng tu hoàn thành trước kế hoạch nhờ sự đóng góp của ông Yagi).

Đoạn chứa đáp án: Work began at the site shortly after Yagi signed an official agreement with the Special Superintendency for the Archaeological Heritage of Rome, and was completed ahead of schedule thanks to his 2-million-euro contribution.

7. FALSE
(Đa số các bức bích họa đã biến mất theo thời gian, chỉ còn lại một số ít).

*Đoạn chứa đáp án:*We know from the writings of earlier visitors that there used to be more here, but the majority have disappeared over time.

8. brick
(Bên trong kim tự tháp được xây dựng từ gạch, xi măng và cẩm thạch bên ngoài).

Đoạn chứa đáp án: Cestius pyramid had a layer of white Carrara marble on the outside, and was constructed from brick held together by a basic kind of cement on the inside

9. shape
(Hình dáng của nó dốc hơn nhiều so với các kim tự tháp điển hình ở Ai Cập).

*Đoạn chứa đáp án:*One of the things that strikes you when you look at the pyramid is how steep it is, so that the shape of Cestius pyramid is quite unlike that of typical Egyptian ones

10. countryside
(Ban đầu nó được xây ở vùng nông thôn vì luật La Mã cấm đặt lăng mộ trong thành phố).

*Đoạn chứa đáp án:*At the time of its construction, since there was a strict Roman law prohibiting the placement of tombs within the city itself, the Pyramid of Cestius would have stood in countryside

11. statues
(Năm 1660, người ta tìm thấy các mảnh vỡ của tượng đồng phía trước kim tự tháp).

*Đoạn chứa đáp án:*During excavations, when trees and plants were cleared away, two marble bases were found in front of the pyramid, as well as fragments of bronze statues that had once stood on them on either side of the pyramid.

12. tunnel
(Việc tìm thấy một đường hầm bên trong cho thấy những kẻ trộm mộ có thể đã đột nhập).

*Đoạn chứa đáp án:*The people employed to excavate the pyramid did not find the urn that would have contained Cestius' remains, but they did come across a tunnel. It was quite possible, therefore, that robbers had at some earlier time removed the contents of the tomb.

13. pollution
(Các vận động viên leo núi tự do được thuê để làm sạch dấu vết của ô nhiễm đô thị trên bề mặt đá cẩm thạch).

*Đoạn chứa đáp án:*The white exterior of the Pyramid of Cestius will have to be cleaned every few months to remove the layer of urban pollution. A team of free-climbers will be employed to do the job,

READING PASSAGE 2

*You should spend about 20 minutes on **Questions 14–26**, which are based on Reading Passage 2 below.*

The Tasmanian Tiger

The Tasmanian tiger, or thylacine, was a carnivorous marsupial (a meat-eating mammal which carries its young in a pouch). It was given the name 'tiger' because it had striped fur, and because it was ferocious. Between 24 million and 15 million years ago, many types of thylacine roamed across Australia, their powerful jaws playing a role in maintaining a balance in the ecosystems of their day. Some species were fox-sized, while others were barely the size of kittens.

But when a period of climate change cooled Australia about 12 million years ago, the numbers of these ancient thylacines began to decline. By about 3 million years ago, only one species was left. About 4,000 years ago, these vanished completely from the Australian mainland, so that Tasmania, a large island to the south of Australia, became the last remaining place where thylacines existed. They ruled the island's animal life unchallenged until Europeans—with sheep, dogs and a great indifference to native flora and fauna—seem to have brought about their extinction. In 1936, the last captive Tasmanian tiger died in Hobart Zoo. Since then, many expeditions have searched for tigers in the Tasmanian bush, but no definitive evidence has been found. Despite this, there are many who keep searching.

In 1981, Dutch-born zoologist Hans Naarding was in Tasmania conducting a survey of Latham's snipe, a species of endangered bird. One night, he saw an animal in the light from the searchlight mounted on his vehicle. He described it as about the size of a large dog, but with slightly sloping hindquarters and a fairly thick tail continuing straight on from its backbone. He said that it had 12 distinct stripes on its back, running down to the point where the tail began. He reported the sighting to the Director of Tasmania's National Parks. "When the news broke," said Naarding, "I was besieged by television crews, including four or five from Japan, and others from the United Kingdom, Germany, New Zealand and South America."

Government and private search parties combed the region, but no further sightings were made. The tiger, as always, had escaped to its lair—a place that many insist exists only in the imagination. Others disagree: there have been more than 4,000 claimed sightings of the animal since it supposedly died out, and the average number of claims reported to the authorities each year is now 150. So is it out there? Even experts differ in opinion.

Randolph Rose, Associate Professor of Zoology at the University of Tasmania, says that he once dreamed of seeing a thylacine, but is now convinced that his dream will go unfulfilled. The consensus among conservationists is that any animal with a population base of less than 1,000 is headed for extinction within 60 years. "Sixty years ago," he says, "there was only one thylacine that we know of, and that was in Hobart Zoo. Take it from me, the tiger is gone." But Dr David Pemberton, curator of zoology at the Tasmanian Museum, states that, despite scientific thinking that a relatively large population is required to sustain a species, "the Florida panther is down to a dozen or so animals, and, while it does have some

inbreeding problems, it's still ticking along! After all, animals can be notoriously elusive. The strange fish known as the coelacanth, with its 'proto legs,' was thought to have died out with the dinosaurs 700 million years ago, until a specimen was dragged to the surface in a shark net off the coast of South Africa in 1938."

Wildlife biologist Nick Mooney has the unenviable task of investigating all so-called sightings of the tiger. It was Mooney who was first consulted in late February 2005 about the authenticity of new digital photographic images of a thylacine allegedly taken by a tourist. "On face value," Mooney says, "this particular account of a sighting and the photographs submitted as proof amount to one of the most convincing cases for the species' survival that I have seen." Many other 'sightings' have been hoaxes, and many sincere seekers are victims of obsession. "It is a blind optimism that something is, rather than cynicism that something isn't," Mooney says. "If something crosses the road, it's not a case of 'I wonder what that was?' Rather, it is a case of 'That's a thylacine!'"

However, Mooney treats all sightings at face value. "I never try to embarrass people," he says, "but the fact that I don't pack the car immediately after they telephone can often be taken as ridicule. Obsessive characters get angry that someone in my position is not out there when they think the thylacine is there."

Hans Naarding, whose sighting of a striped animal two decades ago was the highlight of a lifetime of animal spotting, remains puzzled by the time and money people waste on tiger searches. He says resources would be better applied to saving another endangered animal, the Tasmanian devil, and helping declining migratory bird populations. Could the thylacine still be out there? "Sure," Naarding says. "I know the vast south-west wilderness of Tasmania well. They could survive … [But] if this is the case, it will not be long before they do disappear completely." Naarding believes that any discovery of surviving thylacines would be "rather pointless." "How do you bring a species back from extinction?" he asks. "What could you do with it? If there are thylacines out there, they are better off right where they are."

Questions 14–18

Complete the summary below.

*Choose **NO MORE THAN TWO WORDS AND/OR A NUMBER** from the passage for each answer.*

*Write your answers in boxes **14–18** on your answer sheet.*

The thylacine was a dog-like animal which had a **14** ..... coat and was carnivorous. It was originally spread widely throughout the mainland of **15** ..... . However, the number of thylacine decreased in that area around **16** ..... ago because of climate change.

In the end, thylacines were found only on the island of **17** ....., until the arrival of **18** ..... with their farming practices brought about a drastic reduction in thylacine numbers. The last one is thought to have died in Hobart Zoo in 1936.

Questions 19–24

Look at the following statements (Questions 19–24) and the list of people below.

*Match each statement with the correct person, **A, B, C or D**.*

*Write the correct letter, **A–D**, in boxes 19–24 on your answer sheet.*

***NB** You may use any letter more than once.*

19 There is no longer any hope of finding a surviving Tasmanian tiger.

20 It would be preferable not to disturb any surviving Tasmanian tigers.

21 Many who claim to have seen Tasmanian tigers are not objective witnesses.

22 Expert estimates of numbers needed to ensure species survival may be inaccurate.

23 There is a great deal of international interest in Tasmanian tiger stories.

24 Some fresh evidence provided by a visitor to Tasmania seems credible.

List of People

A Hans Naarding
B Randolph Rose
C David Pemberton
D Nick Mooney

Questions 25 and 26

Choose the correct letter, ***A, B, C or D****.*

Write the correct letter in boxes 25 and 26 on your answer sheet.

25 Has Naarding's sighting of a Tasmanian tiger resulted in

A the capture of the tiger.
B an extensive follow-up.
C many other sightings.
D the death of the tiger.

26 The example of the coelacanth is used to show that

A new animal species are still evolving.
B animals can possess surprising physical characteristics.
C species of sea animals can be saved from extinction.
D opinions regarding the extinction of animal species can be mistaken.

TRUE IELTS

ĐÁP ÁN:

14. striped

Paragraph 1 says it was named "tiger" because it had striped fur.

15. Australia

Paragraph 1 says, "Between 24 million and 15 million years ago, many types of thylacine roamed across Australia...".

16. 12 million years

But when a period of climate change cooled Australia about 12 million vears ago the numbers of these ancient thylacines began to decline. By about 3 million years ago, only one species was left...

17. Tasmania

Paragraph 2 states that after vanishing from the mainland, Tasmania "was then the last remaining place where thylacines existed."

18. Europeans

Paragraph 2 says they ruled Tasmania until "Europeans with sheep, dogs... seem to have brought about their extinction."

19. B (Randolph Rose: "...convinced that his dream will go unfulfilled... the tiger is gone.")

20. A (Hans Naarding: "...they are better off right where they are.")

21. D (Nick Mooney: "...many sincere seekers are victims of obsession... 'That's a thylacine!'")

22. C (David Pemberton: "...despite scientific thinking that a relatively large population is required... the Florida panther is... still ticking along!")

23. A (Hans Naarding: "...I was besieged by television crews, including four or five from Japan, and others from the United Kingdom...")

24. D (Nick Mooney: "...photographic images... allegedly taken by a tourist... amount to one of the most convincing cases...")

25. B (an extensive follow-up: "Government and private search parties combed the region...")

26. D (opinions regarding the extinction of animal species can be mistaken: ví dụ về loài cá coelacanth được cho là đã tuyệt chủng nhưng sau đó lại tìm thấy mẫu vật sống)

TRUE IELTS

READING PASSAGE 3

*You should spend about 20 minutes on **Questions 27–40**, which are based on Reading Passage 3 below.*

The tuatara – past and future

The New Zealand species of lizard, the tuatara, is firmly embedded in the national psyche: an icon for today which dates from the age of dinosaurs; an ancient reptile commemorated on the back of the five-cent coin. New Zealanders feel an affinity with the tuatara, and accept that active conservation management is required to ensure it will be among the legacies left to future generations.

When European explorers reached New Zealand in 1769 they found two large islands, which together they called *the mainland*, and many tiny offshore islands around the coast. The naturalists who came with the explorers disregarded the tuatara, though it is improbable none were seen. Only several decades later did a tuatara specimen reach the British Museum, where it was eventually classified as just another type of lizard.

One of the first scientists who realised that aspects of tuatara anatomy were odd—unchanged for tens of thousands of years—was Albert Gunther in 1876. Gunther believed the tuatara was one of the most valuable objects in zoological anatomical collections, and also noted, in passing, the reptile was likely to become extinct. From today's perspective, it is striking that Gunther expressed no concern about the probable demise of the tuatara. He and his contemporaries were products of their age, strongly influenced by Charles Darwin's theory, which had only recently been published. Their views were something like this: 'Extinction is a natural process. It is sad that species disappear, but that is part of nature.'

There is a second important aspect of Gunther's work. He recorded, correctly, that some of the mammals introduced by Europeans were predators of the tuatara—particularly rats. But what he did not realise was that New Zealand has two species of rat, both introduced, both with an appetite for tuatara: the ship's rat came with European explorers and settlers; but the kiore rat had already been in the country for hundreds of years, brought by Polynesians from the Pacific Islands. Gunther failed to recognise the distinction, believing all rats to be a relatively recent introduction.

Little further research was conducted until Ian Crook of the NZ Wildlife Service published his findings in 1973, which can be summarised as follows. Tuatara thrive on offshore islands with no rats. Tuatara never survived on islands with ship's rats. On a few islands, small and declining populations of tuatara occur with the kiore. This should not be seen, however, as evidence that tuatara and kiore can coexist. Rather, Crook proposed, kiore probably only arrived recently on such islands, and thus the small populations represent extinctions in progress.

Throughout the 1990s, Richard Holdaway and his colleagues at Victoria University in Wellington documented the surprising discovery that kiore probably arrived about 1,800 years ago, although the human population of New Zealand is thought to be no older than 800 years. How is this possible? Presumably, Holdaway argued, the kiore were brought by Polynesian explorers who visited the country but did not settle. Thereafter, the rats were agents of ecological warfare, exterminating perhaps 1,000–3,000 species. Thus, tuatara and many other species were already rare or extinct when permanent human inhabitants—the Maori—arrived around 1300. This hypothesis is still being debated, but the evidence continues to accumulate in its favour.

Conservation practice has changed dramatically since Crook's findings were published in 1973. Eradication of rats from any given environment was believed to be virtually impossible until about 1980, but since then has become routine. Enormous conservation benefits are accruing as newly rat-free offshore islands are providing sanctuaries for the country's rarest species. In 1995, for example, Nicola Nelson of the Department of Conservation established 68 tuatara on Titi Island. Since then, four more populations of tuatara have been established elsewhere under similar conditions. Today, numbers of tuatara are still a fraction of what they once were, but for the first time in 1,800 years the decline has been reversed.

While the recovery of rare species is itself a good thing, the truly significant outcome of this research is that it liberates the imagination. If we can remove predatory introduced mammals from islands, why not from the mainland too? Perhaps the questions we ask should demonstrate even more visionary ambition. Can non-mammalian pests also be removed from the mainland? Our rivers, for example, are full of surrogate rats, in the form of introduced species of fish called trout. Some day more people will understand that trout have replaced a whole native fauna in our waterways, just as rats replaced tuatara on the mainland. Will such knowledge lead to the creation of mainland 'aquatic islands' where we can once again establish those species of indigenous fish that used to live in our rivers? Similarly, can bellbirds and tuis replace birds like starlings and mynahs?

The answers to such questions are uncertain, and opposing sides will doubtless be fiercely debated. But the role of scientific knowledge in illuminating the past will be crucial. Just as we no longer tolerate extinction, in the future we may no longer accept a mainland devoid of the biological wonders of our past such as tuatara. Conservation is thus not primarily about the past but about imagining and then creating the future we wish for our children and ourselves. For 80 million years until humans arrived, tuatara occurred throughout New Zealand—might they do so again?

TRUE IELTS

Questions 27–31

Choose the correct letter, ***A, B, C or D****.*

Write the correct letter in boxes 27–31 on your answer sheet.

27 What are we told about the Europeans who arrived in 1769?

A They thought there was only one large island.
B They had not come to study natural history.
C They had no interest in the tuatara.
D They sent a tuatara to the British Museum.

28 What does the writer say about Albert Gunther in the third paragraph?

A He believed the tuatara could fetch a high price.
B He was typical of his generation of scientists.
C He disagreed with Charles Darwin's theory.
D He wanted to stop the tuatara becoming extinct.

29 What did Albert Gunther think about the rats in New Zealand?

A They did not eat the tuatara.
B There was one species of rat.
C There had always been rats in New Zealand.
D They were killed by Polynesians.

30 What did Ian Crook conclude from his research?

A Tuatara are safe on small islands.
B Ship's rats kill more tuatara than kiore.
C Kiore cannot swim to offshore islands.
D Rats and tuatara cannot live together.

31 What were the findings of Richard Holdaway's research?

A Maori settled more recently than previously thought.
B The first Polynesian explorers formed permanent settlements.
C Ship's rats are the oldest rat species in the country.
D Rats caused extinctions before any humans settled.

Questions 32–35

Do the following statements agree with the claims of the writer in Reading Passage 3?

In boxes 32–35 on your answer sheet, write

YES — if the statement agrees with the claims of the writer
NO — if the statement contradicts the claims of the writer
NOT GIVEN — if it is impossible to say what the writer thinks about this

32 The available research supports Holdaway's theory but it has not been proved.

33 Nowadays, it is possible to totally destroy a population of rats on a small island.

34 Crook was the first person to recognise the potential of offshore islands as sanctuaries.

35 Tuatara numbers are continuing to fall.

Questions 36–40

*Complete the summary using the list of words, **A–H**, below.*

*Write the correct letter, **A–H**, in boxes 36–40 on your answer sheet.*

What conclusions can we draw?

The most important result of the tuatara research is that it frees our **36** _____. For example, there are many similarities between rats and **37** _____. Should we now go further and consider reintroducing **38** _____ to our mainland rivers? Perhaps our children will come to believe in the **39** _____ of species, in the same way that our generation refuses to accept **40** _____.

A natural evolution
B creative thought
C indigenous plants
D trout
E pollution
F restoration
G native fish
H extinction

ĐÁP ÁN:

27. C (They had no interest in the tuatara)

Giải thích: Các nhà tự nhiên học đi cùng đoàn thám hiểm đã "ngó lơ" (disregarded) loài tuatara, cho thấy họ không quan tâm đến chúng vào thời điểm đó.
Đoạn chứa đáp án: The naturalists who came with the explorers disregarded the tuatara, though it is improbable none were seen.

28. B (He was typical of his generation of scientists)

Giải thích: Tác giả viết Gunther và những người cùng thời là "sản phẩm của thời đại họ" (products of their age), chịu ảnh hưởng mạnh mẽ bởi thuyết tiến hóa của Darwin.
Đoạn chứa đáp án: From today's perspective, it is striking that Gunther expressed no concern about the probable demise of the tuatara. He and his contemporaries were products of their age, strongly influenced by Charles Darwin's theory, which had only recently been published. Their views were something like this: 'Extinction is a natural process. It is sad that species disappear, but that is part of nature.'

29. B (There was one species of rat)

Giải thích: Gunther đã không nhận ra sự khác biệt giữa hai loài chuột, ông tin rằng tất cả chuột đều là giống mới được đưa vào gần đây.
Đoạn chứa đáp án: But what he did not realise was that New Zealand has two species of rat, both introduced, both with an appetite for tuatara: the ship's rat came with European explorers and settlers; but the kiore rat had already been in the country for hundreds of years, brought by Polynesians from the Pacific Islands. Gunther failed to recognise the distinction, believing all rats to be a relatively recent introduction.

30. D (Rats and tuatara cannot live together)

Giải thích: Nghiên cứu của Ian Crook chỉ ra rằng sự hiện diện của chuột đồng nghĩa với việc quần thể tuatara đang trong quá trình tuyệt chủng (extinctions in progress).
Đoạn chứa đáp án: Tuatara never survived on islands with ship's rats. On a few islands, small and declining populations of tuatara occur with the kiore.

31. D (Rats caused extinctions before any humans settled)

Giải thích: Richard Holdaway phát hiện chuột kiore đã đến New Zealand khoảng 1.800 năm trước, gây ra "chiến tranh sinh thái" trước khi con người định cư lâu dài.
Đoạn chứa đáp án: Thereafter, the rats were agents of ecological warfare, exterminating perhaps 1000-3000 species. Thus, tuatara and many other species were already rare or extinct when permanent human inhabitants – the Maori – arrived around 1300.

32. YES

Giải thích: Tác giả cho biết giả thuyết của Holdaway vẫn đang được tranh luận nhưng bằng chứng đang tiếp tục tích lũy để ủng hộ nó.
Đoạn chứa đáp án: This hypothesis is still being debated, but the evidence continues to accumulate in its favour.

33. YES

Giải thích: Việc tiêu diệt chuột (eradication) trên các đảo nhỏ hiện đã trở thành công việc "thường quy" (routine).
Đoạn chứa đáp án: Eradication of rats from any given environment was believed to be virtually impossible until about 1980, but since then it has become routine.

34. NOT GIVEN

Giải thích: Bài đọc nói về phát hiện của Crook nhưng không khẳng định ông là người "đầu tiên" nhận ra tiềm năng làm khu bảo tồn của các đảo xa bờ.
Đoạn tham khảo: In 1995, for example, Nicola Nelson of the Department of Conservation established 68 tuatara on Titi Island.

35. NO

Giải thích: Văn bản khẳng định "lần đầu tiên trong 1.800 năm, đà sụt giảm đã được đảo ngược" (decline has been reversed).
Đoạn chứa đáp án: Today, numbers of tuatara are still a fraction of what they once were, but for the first time in 1800 years the decline has been reversed.

36. B (creative thought): Nghiên cứu giải phóng trí tưởng tượng/tư duy sáng tạo của chúng ta (liberates the imagination).
Đoạn chứa đáp án:

While the recovery of rare species is itself a good thing, the truly significant outcome of this research is that it liberates the imagination.

37. D (trout): Tác giả so sánh chuột với cá hồi (trout) như một loài ngoại lai gây hại dưới nước.
Đoạn chứa đáp án:

Our rivers, for example, are full of surrogate rats, in the form of introduced species of fish called trout. Some day more people will understand that trout have replaced a whole native fauna in our waterways, just as rats replaced tuatara on the mainland.

38. G (native fish): Đề xuất đưa các loài cá bản địa (indigenous/native fish) trở lại các dòng sông.
Đoạn chứa đáp án:

Our rivers, for example, are full of surrogate rats, in the form of introduced species of fish called trout. Some day more people will understand that trout have replaced a whole native fauna in our waterways, just as rats replaced tuatara on the mainland.

39. F (restoration): Con cái chúng ta có thể tin tưởng vào sự phục hồi (restoration) các loài sinh vật.

Đoạn chứa đáp án:

Will such knowledge lead to the creation of mainland 'aquatic islands' where we can once again establish those species of indigenous fish that used to live in our rivers?

40. H (extinction): Thế hệ hiện nay không còn chấp nhận sự tuyệt chủng (extinction) của các loài.

Đoạn chứa đáp án:

Just as we now no longer tolerate extinction, in the future we may no longer accept a mainland devoid of the biological wonders of our past such as tuatara.

TRUE IELTS